Daily Banking Service FAQ

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Document control

Document status	Version	Applies to
Fictional / demo only	1.0	Test chatbot and RAG retrieval only

1. Purpose and scope

This FAQ describes the demo servicing rules used by the Apex Bank Daily Banking Assistant. It covers account balances, recent transactions, authentication, privacy, service failures, and escalation. The assistant must use the authenticated customer context and approved banking tools for customer-specific information.

The assistant must distinguish account data from general policy information. Policy text can explain a rule, but it cannot establish a particular customer's balance, payment status, eligibility, card status, or dispute outcome.

2. Available balance and ledger balance

Ledger balance is the posted balance recorded in the account ledger. Available balance is the amount currently available for withdrawal or spending after applicable holds, restrictions, and pending adjustments have been considered.

The available balance may be lower than the ledger balance because of a card authorization hold, a pending debit, a lien, a scheduled debit, or an account restriction. The difference must not be guessed. If the banking system does not return the reason, the assistant should say that the reason is not available and offer the transaction or account-support route.

Example for testing only: ledger balance INR 128,500; applicable hold INR 3,500; available balance INR 125,000. This example is illustrative and must not be treated as live customer data.

3. Authentication and access

Before returning account-specific information or initiating an account action, the application must authenticate the customer and verify that the requested account, card, loan, payment, or transaction belongs to that customer. A customer identifier supplied in free text or in an untrusted request body is not proof of ownership.

Never reveal one customer's balance, contact details, card information, transactions, loan information, offers, or dispute records to another customer. Administrative functions require a separately authorized bank-employee role.

The assistant must not ask a customer to provide a password, one-time passcode, CVV, full card number, or complete authentication secret in chat. If authentication fails, return an authentication error rather than substituting a demo identity.

4. Transaction history and missing data

Transaction history must be retrieved from the authorized transaction system. When the customer asks for a date range such as this month, the query must apply the requested date range and use a clearly defined timezone.

If an account, transaction, payment reference, bill, loan, or card cannot be found, say that it could not be located. Do not invent a value, select the first unrelated record, or convert an upstream timeout into a zero balance.

If two or more records match a merchant or description, ask the customer to identify the transaction using a date, amount, or reference number before making a claim about its status.

5. Disputed or suspicious activity

When a customer reports a transaction they do not recognize, retrieve the transaction only after verifying ownership. Show the merchant, amount, date, and reference available from the authorized source. Fraud scores are risk indicators and are not proof that a transaction is fraudulent.

Creating a dispute request means that the request has been recorded; it does not mean that the dispute has been approved, a refund has been issued, or provisional credit has been granted. Report each status exactly as returned by the dispute system.

Sensitive actions must follow the application's verified action workflow. Customer confirmation, bank-employee approval, and successful execution are separate events and must not be conflated.

6. Reliability and response wording

The assistant should identify whether a response is calculated from banking data, retrieved from a policy document, or associated with a requested action. Include a source or policy name for policy answers when the interface supports citations.

If a banking system is unavailable, state that the information could not be retrieved at this time. Do not claim data is real-time unless it was actually fetched from the approved source. Do not claim an action succeeded until its result is confirmed by the relevant system.

For a calculation such as remaining funds, list the balance used, each included upcoming obligation, the total obligations, and the arithmetic. Avoid double-counting the same EMI or card due appearing in more than one data source.

7. Frequently asked questions

Q: What is the difference between available balance and ledger balance?
A: Ledger balance reflects posted account entries. Available balance reflects funds available now after applicable holds and restrictions.

Q: Can the assistant tell me another customer's balance?
A: No. Customer-specific data may be returned only to an authenticated and authorized customer for their own account.

Q: What if the assistant cannot find a transaction?
A: It should say that the transaction was not found and ask for a transaction ID, reference number, date, or amount if needed.

Q: Does “dispute created” mean the refund has been paid?
A: No. Dispute creation, dispute approval, refund, and provisional credit are separate statuses.

Q: What should the assistant do if banking data is unavailable?
A: Explain that the system could not retrieve the data, avoid guessing, and provide a safe retry or support route.

Implementation note: The assistant must prioritize authenticated, customer-specific system data for account facts and actions. Use this document only to answer general policy questions, and identify it as demo policy if asked about its source.